DIGITAL LITERACY PROJECT

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Branch: CSE-AI/ML

Course Code: CSE0001

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Project Overview

This project has been created as a comprehensive digital hub for a range of resources that aims to equip students with the fundamental skills of the modern world of technology. **As a Student Digital Ambassador**, I have created a multi-modular toolkit that bridges the world of academia and the world of digital citizenship. The project includes five key areas: visual communication, professional branding, collaborative coding, digital etiquette, and cybercrime awareness.

Project Scenario

In an age where the landscape of professionalism is dominated by the presence of AI and digital platforms, students are facing issues such as complex UPI scams and ensuring a competitive digital presence. This project was created as a persona of a **Digital Ambassador** to develop a "safety-first" culture among students.

The scenario involves:

- **Educating Peers:** Creating high-impact visuals and quizzes to simplify complex security concepts.
- **Professional Readiness:** Setting up industry-standard profiles (GitHub, LinkedIn) to prepare for internship cycles.
- **Threat Mitigation:** Researching real-world financial fraud (UPI) and providing actionable prevention strategies tailored to the Indian digital ecosystem.

Task 1: Design Reflection & Tool Overview

I designed a professional one-pager infographic for the module with the title "What is Digital Literacy?" I chose to work with the tool Canva for the task. This is because the tool has a wide variety of educational icons, which enabled me to create a high-quality visual resource for the batchmates.

The infographic I designed meets the objectives of the task by effectively addressing the three main pillars of digital literacy. This includes the definition of digital literacy, a carefully selected list of academic digital tools such as Zotero and Trello, and the importance of safe internet practices such as passwords and phishing.

The most interesting part of the task for me was the challenge of visual hierarchy. This is because, as a CSE-AIML student, I am more accustomed to focusing on visualizations. However, the task required me to simplify complex security concepts and present them in the form of icons. The challenge of balancing white space and informative content was also difficult and interesting, as it taught me the importance of effectively communicating security tips to the batchmates.

Task 2: Portfolio Development & Professional Branding

I have established my professional digital presence by setting up and optimizing accounts on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. I have chosen these three platforms as they represent the essential pillars for a student of the CSE-AIML branch. I have successfully initialized a profile README repository on GitHub.I have ensured that it clearly states my name, branch, and the year of study. I have also added a goal-oriented statement of interest in the domain of deep learning and scalable AI models. I have also optimized my LinkedIn account by ensuring that the current academic details are added to the profile. This is to ensure that the institution and the expected year of graduation are clearly stated for potential internship coordination.

I intend to utilize these platforms as a 'living resume' over the next four years. I intend to utilize GitHub to document the evolution of the projects I work on, LinkedIn to network with industry leaders and alumni, and Kaggle to hone my machine learning skills.

Task 3: Exploration of the Coding & Collaboration Ecosystems

For the technological aspect of this module, I used the HackerRank platform to complete a basic coding challenge. For this task, I focused on the "Python: Hello World" section, which help users establish a basic level of proficiency in their primary programming language. As a CSE-AIML major, these platforms are crucial for a student like me, as they allow me to practice data structures and algorithms, which is vital for any programming interview. The screenshot of the task is located in the project folder, which shows the execution of the task and the progress badge achieved.

For the collaboration task, I created a Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz using Google Forms. The form consists of five targeted questions, which include multiple-choice questions related to cybersecurity. Additionally, the form includes a short-answer section related to fact-checking. To achieve the full functionality of the form, the form is linked to a Google Sheet, which helps me handle the real-time data collected. The HackerRank platform will help me improve my competitive programming skills over the next four years, while Google Workspace will allow me to collaborate effectively with my peers.

Task 4: Digital Communication & Professional Etiquette

In my research for this module, I analyzed a case where a student’s casual tone in an email to a professor—using "hey" and omitting a subject line—led to their request being ignored. This resulted in a missed deadline and a lower grade. This scenario highlights that digital communication is an extension of professional identity. To prevent this, I drafted templates that prioritize a formal salutation, a descriptive subject line, and a concise body. These ensure that the recipient can quickly identify the sender and the urgency of the request.

The most significant learning from this task was that professionalism isn't just about politeness; it’s about clarity and efficiency. By creating the Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist, I realized how easily a single "digital footprint" error can impact one's career. My key takeaway is that every email or post should be treated as a permanent record. Moving forward, I will always use the "24-hour rule"—reviewing important digital communications with a fresh eye before hitting send to ensure the tone is appropriate and the information is complete.

Task 5: Cybercrime Research & Personal Reflection

What surprised me the most while researching the "Request-to-Pay" fraud related to UPI was the level of

sophistication and simplicity of social engineering tactics. I found it quite surprising that the fraudsters do not really "hack" the systems but rather use the psychological pressure of a "limited-time offer" or "urgency of verification" to get the user to reveal their PIN. I found it quite enlightening that even tech-savvy students like myself are prone to getting fooled if we get distracted or do not know that the UPI PIN is only needed to send but never to receive funds.

With regards to what I have learned from researching the "Request-to-Pay" fraud related to UPI, I have learned one important thing that I will personally do differently. I used to occasionally check my bank balance using public Wi-Fi without a second thought. However, I have now committed myself to using a VPN service for all my financial transactions and will ensure that I only use my mobile data service for my bank transactions. I have also shared the Helpline number 1930 with my immediate circle of friends so that we all know what to do in the "Golden Hour" of fraud.

Conclusion

This entire project, as a Digital Ambassador, has been a transformative experience in understanding the importance of the interplay between technology and responsibility. While the basic idea of this project is to

become proficient in using tools like Canva, GitHub, and Google Workspace, the bigger idea of digital responsibility and the importance of critical thinking in this regard have become quite apparent.

The entire exercise of creating a professional portfolio and understanding the practical implications of threats like UPI scams has made me realize that the most valuable thing a student can possess is their digital footprint. The most important thing that this entire exercise has made me realize is that while technology is constantly in a state of evolution, the importance of clear communication, verified facts, and security habits remains the same. This entire project not only prepares me for the opportunities that lie ahead in the field of CSE-AIML, but it also gives me the knowledge and the power to lead my community of peers.

References

1. Digital Literacy & Professional Presence (Tasks 1 & 2)

American Library Association (ALA).

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2. Tools & Collaboration (Task 3)

Google Workspace Learning Center

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3. Communication & Etiquette (Task 4)

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4. Cybercrime & Prevention (Task 5)

National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal. Government of India.

The primary source for reporting and Indian legal context.

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